

protected_areas_matching_key

1. Ia – Strict Nature Reserve Definition: Areas strictly protected to preserve biodiversity and geological features; human visitation and use limited to scientific research, monitoring, and education. Examples:
 - Mount Nimba Strict Nature Reserve (Guinea/Côte d’Ivoire)
 - Aldabra Special Reserve (Seychelles)Objective: Scientific research & monitoring only
2. II – National Park Definition: Large natural or near-natural areas set aside to protect ecological processes, species and ecosystems; also provide for education, recreation and visitor opportunities. Examples:
 - Yellowstone National Park (USA)
 - Banff National Park (Canada)Objective: Ecological process & recreation
3. III – Natural Monument or Feature Definition: Areas set aside to protect a specific natural monument (landform, sea mount, geological or living feature); generally small with high visitor value. Examples:
 - Devils Tower National Monument (USA)
 - Rio São Francisco Natural Monument (Brazil)Objective: Protect a specific feature / Feature protection & interpretation
4. IV – Habitat/Species Management Area Definition: Areas managed primarily through active intervention (e.g., habitat restoration, invasive-species control, species monitoring) to protect particular species or habitats. Examples:
 - Don Edwards San Francisco Bay National Wildlife Refuge (USA)
 - CSKT Bison Range (USA)Objective: Active habitat/species management
5. V – Protected Landscape/Seascape Definition: Areas where people–nature interaction over time has created a landscape of distinct ecological, biological, cultural and scenic value, and where safeguarding that interaction is vital. Examples:
 - Lake District National Park (UK)
 - Tsugaru Quasi-National Park (Japan)Objective: Maintain cultural–ecological interaction / Cultural–ecological stewardship
6. VI – Protected Area with Sustainable Use Definition: Generally large areas, mostly in a natural condition, where a proportion is under sustainable natural-resource management and low-level non-industrial use compatible with conservation. Examples:
 - Ngorongoro Conservation Area (Tanzania)
 - Chico Mendes Extractive Reserve (Brazil)Objective: Sustainable resource use